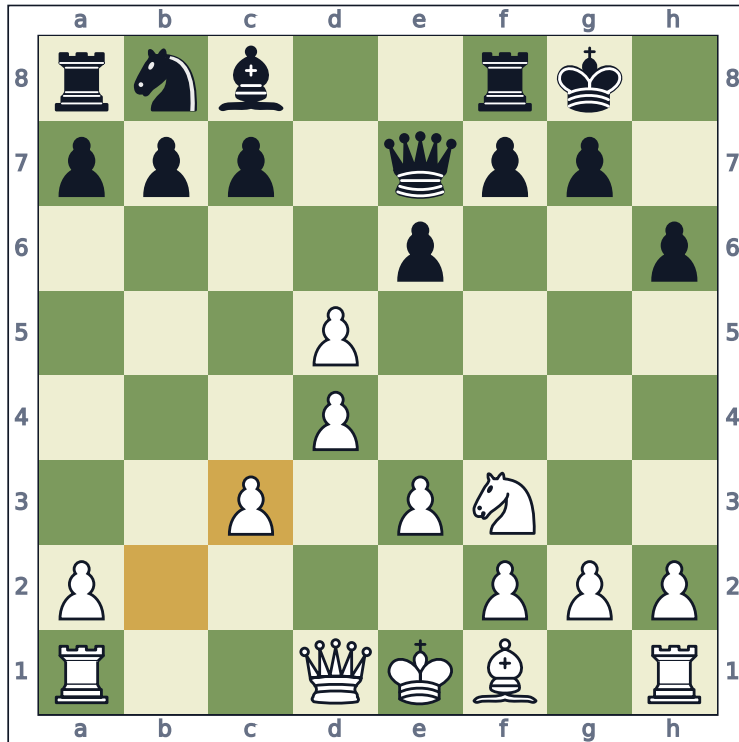


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D57 | 3 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.14 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D57 covers Queen's Gambit Declined. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Queen's Gambit Declined: Lasker Defense, Main Line.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Be7 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. Bg5 h6 6. Bh4 O-O 7. e3 Ne4 8. Bxe7 Qxe7 9. cxd5 Nxc3 10. bxc3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines. a gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. White is ahead by about 1 pawn unit. Central markers: White pawn on c3, White pawn on d4, White pawn on d5, White pawn on e3, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D57 line

This section preserves all 3 names and defining routes assigned to D57 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Lasker Defense, Bernstein Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 d5 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 h6 6. Bh4 O-O 7. Nf3 Ne4 8. Bxe7 Qxe7 9. cxd5 Nxc3 10. bxc3 exd5 11. Qb3 Qd6

002 Queen's Gambit Declined: Lasker Defense, Bernstein Variation, Mar del Plata Gambit

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Nf3 h6 7. Bh4 Ne4 8. Bxe7 Qxe7 9. cxd5 Nxc3 10. bxc3 exd5 11. Qb3 Rd8 12. c4 Be6

003 Queen's Gambit Declined: Lasker Defense, Main Line

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Be7 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. Bg5 h6 6. Bh4 O-O 7. e3 Ne4 8. Bxe7 Qxe7 9. cxd5 Nxc3 10. bxc3